

That sinking feeling: The viral Brazilian goal celebration that went badly wrong



Jacy Maranhao instantly regrets his goal celebration CazeTV/YouTube



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Brazilian defender Jacy Maranhao has not scored many goals — just nine across his senior career — so you could understand his excitement at finding the back of the net in Brazilian side Coritiba's 2-1 league win against Chapecoense.

Unfortunately, Coritiba's captain for the evening took his celebrations a little too far.

The hosts were 1-0 up just before half-time when 29-year-old Jacy headed home from a cross, then retrieved the ball from the net, stuffed it up his shirt and raced towards the corner flag.

His ecstasy turned to agony when he vaulted over an advertising hoarding to continue his celebrations in front of Coritiba fans — only to fall straight through the opening for the stairs that lead to the dressing rooms at Estádio Couto Pereira. The trap door is usually kept closed during games, but opens just before half-time.

Concerned team-mates and officials raced to Jacy's aid and he emerged back onto the pitch having injured his ankle while landing on the staircase.

To add insult to injury, the goal was disallowed for offside. Jacy carried on for the rest of the half, but had to be substituted early after the break. Coritiba went on to win 2-1.

Jacy told reporters after the game that he had got carried away, but that his injury wasn't too bad.

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In quotes [carried by Brazilian outlet Globo, he said](#): “I scored the goal and wanted to celebrate with my wife because she’s pregnant. But then I remembered it was my first goal at Couto Pereira stadium, and I also wanted to celebrate with the fans, but I hadn’t remembered there was a moat there.

“When I jumped, you know when you dream you’re falling from a building? That’s what it was like.”

Jacy is not the first Coritiba player to get that sinking feeling.

In 2014, striker Joel fell down the same opening after scoring in a 3-1 victory against Sao Paulo. Globo reported that the nearby steward who helped Joel on that occasion was the [same person who was nearest to Jacy when he fell through the trapdoor 12 years later](#). Coritiba poked fun at the similarities in a post on their social media channels:

Like in so many stadiums in Brazil, the changing rooms are subterranean — historically in the country, concrete moats were built around the pitch to prevent pitch invasions.

They are also used for the safety of players and officials when crowds turn volatile.

From the moment they arrive at the stadium, players and officials are kept away from the public and can quickly head back underground from the pitch if there is trouble in the stands.

When other celebrations have backfired...

During this summer's World Cup, England midfielder Jordan Henderson broke his arm falling over the advertising hoardings at Estadio Azteca after celebrating England's epic round-of-16 win against tournament co-hosts Mexico.

Jacy and Henderson may not have meant their own acrobatics, but Lomana LuaLua did in April 2006, when he marked a Premier League goal for Portsmouth against Arsenal with his trademark backflip.



Henderson broke his arm falling over advertising hoardings during the World Cup Martín Fonseca/Eurasia Sport Images/Getty Images

Then-Portsmouth coach Harry Redknapp had warned the DR Congo international against the celebration because of the risk of injury. The result was an ankle injury which meant he had to be substituted.

“He still did his triple somersault with pike without realising he’d hurt himself,” [Redknapp said afterwards](#). “He’s a one-off.”

Arsenal defender Steve Morrow broke his right arm during post-match celebrations after scoring the winning goal in the 1993 League Cup final against Sheffield Wednesday. Captain Tony Adams attempted to pick him up onto his shoulders after the game but dropped his team-mate, who had to be taken away in an ambulance straight from the pitch.

His season was over, but he returned to collect his winner’s medal from the royal box at Wembley Stadium before the FA Cup final, which Arsenal also won against Sheffield Wednesday.

Rob Tanner Rob has been a journalist for twenty years and for the past ten he has covered Leicester City, including their Premier League title success of 2016. He is the author of 5000-1, The Leicester City Story.

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